sion over it among the sponsors. Apart from the cash donations, many of the early pledges after the disaster had been for houses for the displaced. Some of them have now baulked at the relatively high costs involved.

The state cabinet has approved two new townships, to be built on 58.5 ha. and 49 ha. of the Nedumbala Estate in Kottapadi village and Elstone Estate in Kalpetta village respectively. That too had gone into litigation owing to land issues but the Kerala High Court has now cleared the acquisition.

SHIFTING EARTH

↘ Centre refuses extra funds, says Kerala has enough in its state relief kitty to manage Wayanad rebuilding

↘ CPI(M)-led state govt to rehabilitate survivors by itself. Some early pledgers baulk at high costs

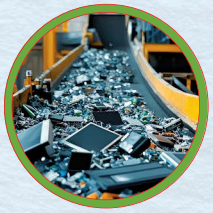
The relief efforts have also led to a war of words between the CPI(M) and the Opposition. "We are committed to setting up model villages for the victims. Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited the victims for his PR shows but didn't give Wayanad a penny," says CPI(M) politburo member A. Vijayaraghavan. BJP state president K. Surendran refutes the allegations. "The Left government has escalated the costs to loot the money. As for rehabilitation funds, the Centre will provide whatever is necessary," he says.

For sure, the reconstruction efforts will be a hot potato issue in the next assembly poll. Besides the BJP, Pinarayi knows he has a chance to show up the Congress—what with Wayanad having a high-profile MP in Priyanka Gandhi. But it could also blow up in his face. The CPI(M) has seen a rash of scandals in the recent past, and this may be the CM's last chance to redeem himself and the party after two terms in power. Any missteps and voters will be unforgiving in 2026. ■

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Weak Recycling Infrastructure:
Limited Recovery Systems





Poor Disposal Practices:
Inefficient Waste Management

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